

CHOOSING THE RIGHT FEMININE HYGIENE PRODUCTS

A Guide to Period Care

Managing your period comfortably starts with choosing the right menstrual products for your body and lifestyle. There are many types of period products available today, and each one works differently.

Some products are external, meaning they are worn outside the body, while others are internal, meaning they are inserted into the vagina to absorb or collect menstrual flow.

External Period Products

Sanitary Pads

- Worn inside underwear to catch menstrual blood
- Often include adhesive strips and wings
- Available as liners, regular pads, super pads, and overnight pads

Period Underwear

- Reusable underwear designed to absorb menstrual flow
- Can be worn for several hours depending on flow
- Washable and reusable

Internal Period Products

Tampons

- Small absorbent products inserted into the vagina
- Usually include a string for removal
- Come in different absorbencies
- Should generally be changed every 4 to 6 hours

Menstrual Cups

- Reusable cups made from medical-grade materials
- Collect blood instead of absorbing it
- Can often be worn for up to 10 to 12 hours depending on flow

Pads come in many varieties, including different absorbencies, materials, and shapes.

Absorbency

- Panty liners for very light flow or spotting
- Regular pads for moderate bleeding
- Super or overnight pads for heavier flow

Materials

- Synthetic materials
- Organic cotton
- Bamboo-based fabrics

Design

- Wings for extra protection
- Thin designs for comfort
- Longer or overnight shapes for heavier flow

Menstrual Hygiene Tips

Important hygiene practices include:

- Changing menstrual products regularly
- Washing hands before and after changing products
- Choosing fragrance-free products to reduce irritation
- Cleaning the vulva gently with water or mild soap
- Avoiding douching

The right option depends on:

- Comfort
- Flow level
- Daily activities
- Personal preference
- Environmental considerations

Some people use different products at different stages of their cycle depending on flow and convenience.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by Moreland OB-GYN. Choosing the Best Feminine Hygiene Products: A Complete Guide.